
A WORKING FRAMEWORK

The Four-Move Method

A discipline for deciding, built in four moves. Use it whenever a decision is expensive to get wrong and there's no case study to consult: the offer, the partnership, the expansion, the exit.

01

Frame the decision

Separate what's reversible from what isn't. Most anxiety about a decision comes from treating a two-way door like a one-way one. Name which kind you're actually facing before you do anything else.

02

Widen the aperture

Surface the options you haven't let yourself consider: the third path between "stay" and "go" that ambition tends to hide from view. Write down at least one option you've been avoiding.

03

Price the trade-off

Put a number, or at minimum a rank, on what you're giving up. Vague regret becomes a legible cost you can actually weigh against what you stand to gain.

04

Decide on record

Commit in writing, with a date to revisit it. A decision without a record is just a mood you'll have to have again. Put a line in your calendar to check your own work.

HOW TO USE IT

Work through the four moves in order, in writing, before you decide. Most people skip straight to move three, pricing a trade-off they haven't actually framed or widened first, which is why the same decision keeps resurfacing. Ten honest minutes with this page will tell you more than another week of thinking about it.